

KRISHNA KURKAL

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SENIOR IT MANAGEMENT EXECUTIVE: Seasoned Technical Leadership, IT Solution Architecture & Cloud Strategist & Project Lead

Recognized as a **Cloud Solutions Evangelist** for cloud management business units with rich experience in steering external IT service providers and leading IT Projects. Technology Lead for hosted applications in large datacenter and production environments for big brands including Aspect Software, Electronic Arts, Vist Intl, The Home Depot, ADP, GE Healthcare, FDA, USDA, Compuware Corp, Reed Elsevier, ServiceMesh Inc., mPortal Inc. and more

Recorded vast improvements in new technology capabilities development, Cloud Computing, Virtualization, Hosted Applications, IT Infrastructure, Applications Management (mission critical), Fraud and Performance Management with world-renowned organizations. **Techno-Managerial skills** in orchestrating cross-functional teams and setting common agendas in 'IT Strategy Development', Planning and 'Decisions'.

Over 25 years of expertise across: ☐ Cloud Computing ☐ DevOps ☐ Virtualization ☐ Hosted Applications ☐ IT Infrastructure ☐ Business Consulting & Solutioning ☐ Product Strategy & Brainstorming & Roadmap ☐ Change Management ☐ Applications Management ☐ Systems Monitoring ☐ Requirements Elicitation ☐ Fraud and Performance Management ☐ Traceability Matrix ☐ User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

<u>Domain Vertical Exposure</u>	► Gaming ☐ SAN Storage ☐ Financial Services ☐ ERP ☐ CRM ☐ HealthCare ☐ Oil & Gas ☐ Mobile & e-Commerce
<u>IT Application Implementations & Integration</u>	► Isaac Falcon Fraud Manager ☐ Oracle 11i & Clarify CRM ☐ Corporate Web Sites / Intranets ☐ Tivoli/HP Openview/CA ☐ Java & Spring Apps ☐ CI/CD (Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Harness), GitHub Actions ☐ ServiceMesh
<u>Cloud Computing</u>	► Hybrid Clouds (Servicemesh Agility Platform) ☐ Private Clouds (OpenQRM, Eucalyptus, Abiquo, OpenStack) ☐ Public Clouds (AWS, Azure, GCP) ☐ RightScale, Scalr, DuploCloud ☐ VMWare ☐ Automation (Jenkins, Azure DevOps) ☐ IaaS, PaaS & SaaS ☐ Containers/Kubernetes ☐ JIRA, ServiceNOW, Rally ☐ Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) ☐ DevSecOps ☐ EC2, S3, SNS, SQS, Lambda, CloudFormation, Kinesis, Glue ☐ NetApp Filers
<u>Hosted Applications</u>	► Gaming Infrastructure hosted at RackSpace/MIS3D/Amazon AWS Datacenters ☐ Hosted ERP & CRM Applications - internal customers ☐ Aspect Software ☐ Corporate Website and Intranet in a production environment ☐ Pegasystems
<u>Security</u>	► Security Assessments ☐ SSH and SFTP Protocols Management ☐ SSL Implementation - Web Servers ☐ PGP Encryption ☐ Firewalls (RedHat IPTables) ☐ Virus Protection Software ☐ PCI Compliance ☐ SOX Standards
<u>Virtualization</u>	► Installation & Configuration of VMWare's ☐ Virtual Infrastructure vSphere v5 ☐ vCloud Director v1.5 (ESX/ESXi, DRS, HA, VMotion) ☐ Xen & KVM hypervisors ☐ Docker, Kubernetes, ECS, EKS
<u>Languages & Databases</u>	► C, C++, C#, F#, .NET, Java J2EE, Perl, Python, JavaScript && Oracle, Sybase, MySQL, MSSQL, RDS, DynamoDB, RedShift, Aurora, MongoDB, Snowflake, PostgreSQL, Power BI Dashboards & Reports, Informatica, Pyspark, Kafka

VALUE PROPOSITION:

IT Solution Architecture	Product Lifecycle Management: (Strategy, Project Mgmt, Innovation, Initiation, Design & Deployment)	Cloud Computing (Migration, Virtualization, etc.)
► Architecting highly scalable & performance oriented solutions. Act as Change Diplomat; who can drive highly complex changes for efficiently managing business continuity and ensuring disaster recovery	► Techno-functional role in leading large & complex global product deliveries and managing costs reduction targets & risks. Dexterity to realign work groups (onsite/ offshore) to attain business/ operational goals.	► Orchestrated hybrid clouds, implemented private clouds and public clouds, RightScale, Scalr, OpenStack, VMWare Virtual Infrastructure and Automation (DevOps) and maintainability
► Documenting business needs (functional & non-functional) and translate it to value-driven solutions in close coordination with Business System Partners, stakeholders & IT staff	► Responsible for project management of large projects at Visa Intl, Aspect Software, GE Healthcare, Omnicom etc with a focus on PCI-DSS/SOX Compliance, Fraud Management, as well as other regulatory controls such as GDPR, CIS, NIST, HIPAA etc and Business Continuity measures like HA & DR and managing business system partners and stakeholders	► Dexterous in hosting and managing gaming infrastructures, financial applications, ERP & CRM applications, mission critical projects; leading the delivery of complex Client Infrastructure and Migrations.
► Excel in providing pre-sales functional support by defining how emerging technologies can add instant business value		
► Record of directing mission critical projects to relocate Corporate Website and ERP Applications between different datacenters	► Developing integrations between proprietary NMS products (MaXXan, Luminate and Compuware) with Framework NMS products	► Adept in building Cloud-scale data services focused on providing Infrastructure data service

Certifications & Awards

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• AWS Certified Solutions Architect• Azure Infrastructure Solutions Architect• Google Cloud Digital Leader (GCP)• VMWare & ITIL Certified | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Aviatrix Certified Engineer• Received award for migrating more than 300 apps & exceeding targeted• Introduction to Gen AI, ML & DeepLearning certification course | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Redhat Certified Engineer (RHCE)• Received recognition for productizing TivoliPlus module for EcoTOOLS• Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) Certified |
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■ EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

[Betwixt Labs](#), Plano, TX

Dec '24 – Current Head of Operations

Leading the operations of a stealth-mode startup company on a part-time basis, focused on building a few key products that are aimed at disrupting the IT landscape using AI agents and predominantly open source technologies. Working environment included applications deployed in a managed GCP container service (GKE) and heavy use of open source technologies and Azure Services. Ansible (AWX) was used for automation via playbooks to manage the underlying infrastructure.

[Unisys](#), Houston, TX

May '24 – Nov '24 Client CTO, Cloud, Applications & Infrastructure Group

Working in the CTO office of Unisys's Cloud Consulting line of business and as a Senior Enterprise Architect for its customers, responsibilities included architectural oversight of all cloud infrastructure and operations, along with automated provisioning and secure deployment of cloud-provisioned resources and collaborating with business system partners and managing business stakeholders.

Primary responsibilities involved determining client's needs and expectations, drafting RFS responses in collaboration with other teams, identifying critical aspects of their cloud initiatives, ensuring security and compliance needs are met and converting their requirements into well designed Hybrid Public & Private Cloud Migration solutions for offshore implementation teams to execute.

Other projects included scoping the effort involved in migrating VMWare resources to AWS under the AWS MAP program and bringing unmanaged and non-compliant AWS resources under client managed environment. Virtual Desktop Infrastructure (VDI) environments were built in Azure using AVD for different agencies upon request and based on their specific requirements. Container-based environments were stood up using GCP Kubernetes (GKE). Clients managing were Omnicom and Globelife.

Customer cloud environments included AWS, Azure, GCP cloud providers and VDI initiatives using AVD and AWS Workspaces and Ansible Tower and Python (Boto libraries) were used for automating deployments and CI/CD pipelines.

[Tata Consultancy Services](#), Houston, TX

July '22 – May '24 Enterprise Architect, Cloud Technology Portfolio, EA & Cloud Advisory Unit, CMI-NA

Lead for a short-term Cloud Migration Assessment project for a specific LOB at UHG where multiple portfolios of applications were assessed for suitability of migrating to the Azure Cloud, avenues for modernization to use cloud-native services wherever feasible and estimate the Azure consumption costs and migration costs for all the applications deemed to be in scope. Applications were typically Java based apps and microservices and open source platforms.

Responsible for developing Cloud Advisory offerings for TCS's CMI customers and making presentations and implementing advisory recommendations for the customer. Areas of focus primarily include Cloud Optimize (FinOps Cost Optimization), Cloud Orchestrate (Purpose-fit Multi-cloud Mgmt) and Cloud Refresh (App Modernization) for AWS, Azure and GCP-based environments. Initial implementation of Cloud Optimize at T-Mobile helped identify \$1.5M of sustainable annual cost savings.

Led the cloud infrastructure design and implementation at Thomson Reuters for their SAP cloud migration project targeting AWS cloud, which leveraged a proprietary tool called 'Cloud_Iac' designed to deploy infrastructure as code using CI/CD principles, Github, Terraform, Docker & EKS. High Availability and Disaster Recovery design were both key parts of the considerations to ensure Operational Excellence, Performance Efficiency and costs were optimized. For real-time data streaming and ingestion, AWS Kinesis was used, along with AWS Glue, for near real-time analysis.

Refactored and optimized GCP-hosted applications, improving performance and maintainability by adhering to development best practices. Developed Python automation scripts to streamline cloud operations and system processes across mixed Linux and Windows environments managed by Ansible Tower.

Project lead for a consulting project with Wolters Kluwer where they needed to be advised on the quality of their internal Technical and Architectural Standards by closely inspecting their corporate standards and documentation and making qualitative recommendations based on our collective experiences.

[ASRC Federal](#), Houston, TX

July '21 – July '22 Principal Cloud Solutions Architect

Principal Cloud Solutions Architect at ASRC Federal, responsible for overseeing the Cloud Migration project for FPAC-NRCS mission area within the US Department of Agriculture (USDA) and guiding and mentoring the team from a technical perspective in achieving the set targets in a Scaled Agile (SAFe) environment. Currently, we have successfully migrated USDA's first wave of early adopter applications to the AWS Cloud using the Lift & Shift model and are now focused on migrating the more complex applications which involve re-factoring, re-platforming or leveraging cloud native services.

Responsible for overall architectural design, setting priorities and tasking for the migration team and representing NRCS mission area and ASRC Federal in Scrum of Scrums calls with the customer (FPAC) and all other interactions with the application teams and other 3rd party teams in making key decisions.

Also responsible for new cloud initiatives and working with the CTO office to design cloud solutions for their current and prospective Federal and non-Govt clients for selecting the tools for CI/CD pipelines for different cloud provider environments, designing applications using the AWS Well-Architected Framework, forming a Cloud Center of Excellence group within ASRC and helping ASRC achieving Premier level partner status with AWS. Built and maintained secure, scalable DevSecOps pipelines to enforce CI/CD standards, enhance code quality, and ensure compliance.

[Param Solutions](#), Ashburn, VA

July '19 – Jun '21 Principal Consultant, Cloud Business

Consultant at Param Solutions on different phases of proposal development and project implementation for prospective clients to help grow Param's line of Cloud Consulting business. Directly involved in determining client's needs and expectations, drafting RFP responses, identifying critical aspects of their

Cloud projects and converting their requirements into well designed Hybrid Public & Private Cloud Migration solutions for implementation teams to execute. Customer cloud environments included AWS, Azure, Google Cloud and Openstack based private clouds.

[ADP India Private Ltd](#), Roseland, NJ

Aug '18 – Apr '19 **Director of Infrastructure for APAC Region**

Infrastructure Leader for APAC region, responsible for Compute, Storage, Networking and Cloud Computing capabilities. Led teams responsible for managing remote datacenters located in the US, UK, Canada, Australia, China, Singapore and the Philippines.

Highlights:

- Partner with the Business to create IT strategy & roadmaps while bringing agility and efficiency, and mitigating the security risks presented by the Cloud-based solutions
- Responsible for Budget Planning, Cost Cutting measures and negotiating AMC contracts with Infrastructure vendors such as Amazon, Microsoft, Arista Networks and Network Service Providers like Bharti Airtel & Tata etc
- Key emphasis on automation and taking the toil out of the work, as part of the global Digital Transformation annual goals
- Responsible for planning and designing the new datacenter for the Hyderabad Office relocation project, leveraging new technologies and optimizing infrastructure requirements at the new location
- Implemented multiple Cloud projects under my direct supervision and leadership using Agile methodologies
- Achieved \$2 million cost savings by recouping overallocated Storage (~2 TB), deprovisioning unsupported equipment, systems and software, and reducing Compute resources across all on-prem and Cloud environments and tagged all resources in ServiceNow to provide a single source of truth and to help in automating infrastructure provisioning
- Managed local and remote (Pune, Chennai & China) teams for all project implementations and Ops responsibilities

[TechMahindra](#), Austin, TX

Jan '14 – May '18 **Principal Consultant, Cloud Application Migration**

Highlights:

- AppToCloud datacenter transformation initiative – [General Electric HealthCare](#), Detroit, MI
- Servicemesh's Agility Cloud Management Platform (CMP) implementation to help GEHC's internal business units in migrating their legacy applications to Amazon AWS and an OpenStack-based internal cloud- [General Electric](#), Detroit, MI
- Conducted application assessments as part of a team deputized at Jeppesen, a Boeing company located in Denver, CO
- Designing and enabling the AWS GovCloud for application migration - [FDA/Agilex](#), Washington DC
- Defined and enabled new EMC certified As-A-Service offerings for Cloud Service Providers - [EMC Corp](#), Austin, TX
- Architected the puppet infrastructure and AWS deployments for migrating applications to the AWS public cloud - [Reed Elsevier](#), Philadelphia, PA

Key Deliverables

Cloud Computing + Transformation

- Optimize the delivery of business services at the enterprise level to realize the integrated strategy (business/technology) goals
- Perform Cloud Assessment based on applications, business needs and financial benefits TCO, ROI calculation
 - ✓ Architect GEHC Corporate team's Cloud Migration (App2Cloud) initiatives using Servicemesh's Agility CMP to help their internal business units to migrate legacy applications to the Amazon AWS cloud and Openstack based Private Cloud
 - ✓ App2Cloud 2017 targets: **99%** of business App migration goal achieved (194 out of 196) - GE HealthCare client
 - ✓ Received **Certificate of Appreciation** from TechMahindra for excelling in the App2Cloud cloud migration initiative for GE HealthCare
 - ✓ Cloud Architect role supporting business goals for capacity planning & IT infrastructure by working with cross-matrix teams
 - ✓ Develop Cloud infrastructure automation and orchestration for multi-vendor technologies as per project scope & goals
 - ✓ Led a team of engineers to leverage Serverless Computing using AWS Lambda to perform a POC of Nissan's dealership portal, by rewriting the frontend using AngularJS, NodeJS and integrating with AWS services (API Gateway, S3 & DynamoDB as the backend, used on an iPad by car dealers) and using SSO authentication using Okta & Auth0 using SAML
 - ✓ Created IaaS, PaaS & SaaS stacks in ServiceMesh and CloudFoundry and successfully migrated applications to the target cloud
 - ✓ Successfully migrated hundreds of applications to the AWS Public Cloud for multiple GE internal businesses, namely, HealthCare, Energy Management, Lighting and Oil & Gas business units using Servicemesh's Agility CMP
 - ✓ Performed POC with Scalr CMP tool, draw comparisons between Servicemesh and Scalr and trained internal teams on the same
 - ✓ Typical stacks & Software: LAMP, Java, .NET web apps; IIS, Apache, WebLogic, nginx, Tomcat, MySQL, Oracle, MSSQL, MongoDB, Chef, Puppet, Ansible, Python, Jenkins, Git, Atlassian, Kubernetes, Docker; SDLC & Agile Methodologies

Project Leadership:

- Identify each area of risks and ensuring Performance, Security and Disaster Recovery testing in projects
 - ✓ Led large technical teams located on-shore and off-shore, in executing highly visible application migration projects for GE |
Head - Cloud Application Migration
Focus: Migrate GE HealthCare applications to the Amazon AWS, Azure and OpenStack based public clouds
Scope: Discovery of AS-IS apps in ServiceNow and new apps and designing TO-BE design.
Target set for FY2016 of migrate was 130 applications which was **exceeded** by migrating 150 applications (**115%**) to the Cloud
 - ✓ Led the design and implementation of Xceedium's Xsuite product, privileged identity management tool to enable FDA users to securely access. Monitored / audited capabilities to FDA's security teams

Business Analysis + Consulting + Pre-Sales:

- Interface with new prospective clients in drafting & defining proposals in response to RFI/RFP for applications discovery and migration in a hybrid-cloud based project engagements
- Structure & produce compelling sales proposals and technical documentation by outlining cost savings and business benefits to clients
- Manage all aspects of Business Analysis (Record to Report Process), Business Process Modeling, Business Value Management, ERP Assessment, Business Process Mapping and IT strategy
- Instrument custom policies to suit business unit's specific needs in assigned hostnames to workloads and design deployment policies
 - ✓ Provide consulting service to GE, through Tech-Mahindra, to Servicemesh implementation and help GE's internal business units to migrate legacy applications to Amazon AWS

- ✓ Provided consulting service on defining & enabling new EMC certified as-a-service offerings
- ✓ Delivered innovative as-a-service offerings to end customers by adding an integration module into their infrastructure
- ✓ Applied turnkey approach to ensure end customers easily extend their on-premise capabilities by availing a CSPs new as-a-service offering

Business Collaboration + People Engagement:

- Build business relationships with customer architects, VPs, and C-level executives, GE stakeholders, project and technical teams to identify best practices. Coordinate execution plans across product management and engineering teams
- Harmonize with multiple clients to build IT strategy as well as develop cloud services (both private & public cloud)

ServiceMesh Inc., a CSC/DXC Cloud Business, Austin, TX

Aug '12 – Jan '14 **Cloud Solutions Architect**

Key Deliverables

- Architected Cloud based solutions for ServiceMesh Agility CMP deployment at Fortune 2000 clients
- Implemented Agility CMP at Booz Allen Hamilton in production environment and integrated with legacy enterprise products
- Deployed Agility CMP in the Amazon's new EC2VPC in a multi-account VPC-to-VPC IPsec interconnect using OpenSwan
- Architected and implemented DevOps toolchain based CI/CD setup using Jenkins and Github for multiple customers
- Performed customer Proof of Value trials: **Impact:** Shortened the sales cycle and increased sales, both internally & externally
- Closely interfaced with EMC partner teams on data gathering for the applications targeted for migration to a new datacenter facility
- Implemented a custom Multi-Tenant solution for a Service Provider, Savvis, and ensured the timely submission of the same
- Deployed the Agility CMP in a Managed Service Provider (MSP) model for Dell, Cisco and other clients with the parent instance capable of spinning several child instances in their own siloed VPC environments and managing all their workloads

mPortal Inc., a Mobile Platform Product Company, McLean, VA

Jun '11 – Jul '12 **Cloud Architect**

Key Deliverables

- Led all aspects of mPortal's cloud strategy and architected solutions for customer deployments at Amazon AWS Cloud
- Developed a site-to-site VPN tunnel solution using CohesiveFT and OpenVPN client software to create a secure channel for clear communication with customer's datacenter and route voicemail traffic to the remote handset
- Created a custom search solution by implementing Logstash and Elasticsearch: **Result:** Efficient searching through logfiles
- Implemented Duo security software: **Result:** Enabled 2-factor authentication via SMS while logging into instances
- Setup websites in production, using S3 and ElasticBeanStalk, to facilitate the download of product updates to handsets
- Created a password safe app using WebKeePass to ensure efficient storage of all account credentials
- Setup Open Source products like Xymon, OpenLDAP & SaaS products, Ylastic, Newevm, & Pingdom to better manage deployments
- Engaged with a QSA to get penetration testing & scans performed and fix security holes to ensure product meets security standards

Electronic Arts, Austin, TX

Jan '10 – Jun '11 **IT Architect - Online Integration**

Key Deliverables

RightScale IMPLEMENTATION:

- Served as Key member of **Cloud Management Team** and designed Server Templates for quick deployment of game infrastructure
- Managed RightScripts and Macros for automated deployment of applications fitting a standard application stack like LAMP or other 2-tier or 3-tier applications with an auto-scalable web/app tier, utilizing multi-cloud AMI images, boot scripts to download and install application code or DB schema code from S3 storage, SES for email notification & operational tasks

CLOUD COMPUTING & VIRTUALIZATION

- **Competing Product Offerings Analysis:** OpenQRM | Eucalyptus | RightScale | VMWare vSphere | Dell Advanced Infrastructure Manager | Abiquo & RackSpace Cloud

PUBLIC CLOUD

- **Architect and Lead for:** Projects (hosted in the Amazon AWS, Azure & GCP cloud providers) including: LAMP stack (with few custom components and backend systems assessment) | Elastic Block Storage | Simple Storage Service (S3) | RDS
- **Infrastructure Lead for:** NCAA | Tiger | Madden | SporeLabs
- Internal Project Implementer for InGameAdvertising (relocated from hosting company) and jEA Jobs site (at AWS)
- **AWS Technologies Used:** EIPS, Security Groups | Auto Scaling | Elastic Load Balancing, Simple Email Service (SES), Cloud Front for content delivery network (CDN), CloudWatch for monitoring & RDS for DBs were also heavily used.

GAME INFRASTRUCTURE & DEPLOYMENT

- **Architect for:** key game titles including DeadSpace2 | MassEffect2 | CommandAndConquer | DragonAge2 | Ripper
- **Collaboration & Engagement:** Service Managers | PMs | Bus IT to decide on operational costs, project scheduling and resolving Ops issues

■ PRIOR EXPERIENCES

IT Consultant ▶ **The Home Depot**, Austin, TX

Nov '08 – Nov '09

Sr. Systems Engineer ▶ **Visa Intl**, Austin, TX

Aug '06 – Aug '08

IT Architect - Advanced Applications ▶ **Aspect Software**, San Jose, CA

Jun '03 – Aug '06

Senior Software Engineer ▶ **MaXXan Systems**, San Jose, CA

Jun '01 – May '03

Senior Software Engineer ▶ **Luminate Software Corporation**, Redwood City, CA

Jul '99 – May '01

Senior Software Engineer ▶ **Compuware Corporation**, Campbell, CA (Delivers Software & Services)

Mar '95 – Jul '99

■ ACADEMIC DETAILS

1994 **MS (Computer Science)** from Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

1994 **MS (Petroleum Engineering)** from Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

1991 **BS (Chemical Engineering)** from National Institute of Technology, Durgapur, West Bengal, India